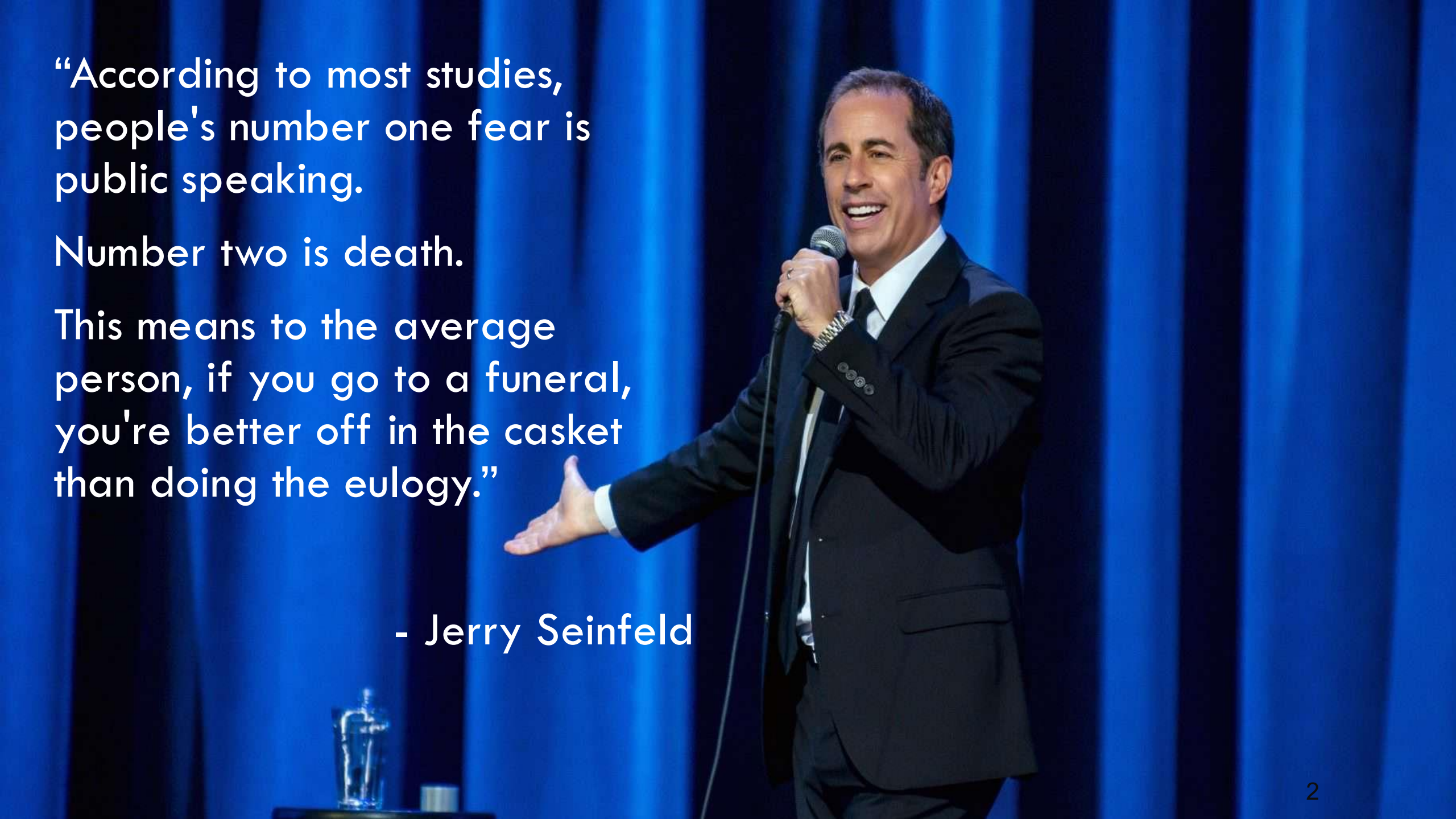
FROM COMMAND LINE TO CENTER STAGE





JAMES MCQUIGGAN

James McQuiggan
@ 35,000 ft
james.mcquiggan.com


“According to most studies, people's number one fear is public speaking.
Number two is death.
This means to the average person, if you go to a funeral, you're better off in the casket than doing the eulogy.”
- Jerry Seinfeld



whoami

James R. McQuiggan



apparentsecurity



CISSP. Certified Information Systems Security Professional
ISC2 Certification

CYBER MANIACS

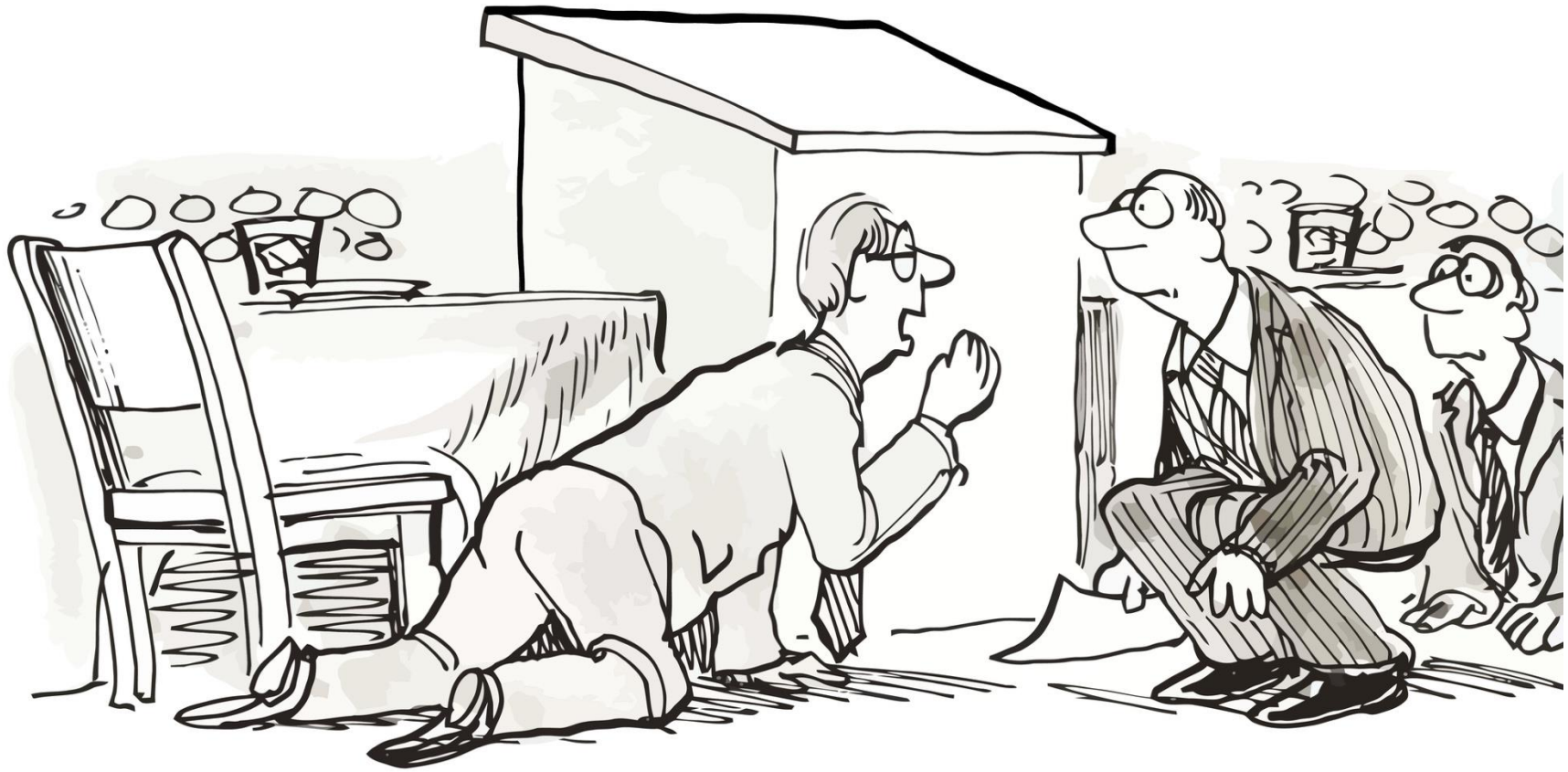
FULL SAIL UNIVERSITY

ISC2 CHAPTER CENTRAL FLORIDA

KnowBe4
SIEMENS



IT'S OKAY TO BE NERVOUS WHEN YOU PRESENT PUBLICLY



**"Of course you're allowed to have stage fright.
As soon as your talk is over."**

JAMES MCQUIGGAN



WHAT ARE WE FRIGHTENED OF WHEN SPEAKING PUBLICLY?

Looking or saying something stupid

Dry mouth

Being asked a difficult question

Forgetting information

The audience boos you or loses interest

Being boring

Not presenting a logical argument

Getting judgement from your boss, peers, subordinates

CONFIDENCE...

...a feeling of self-assurance arising from one's appreciation of one's own abilities or qualities.



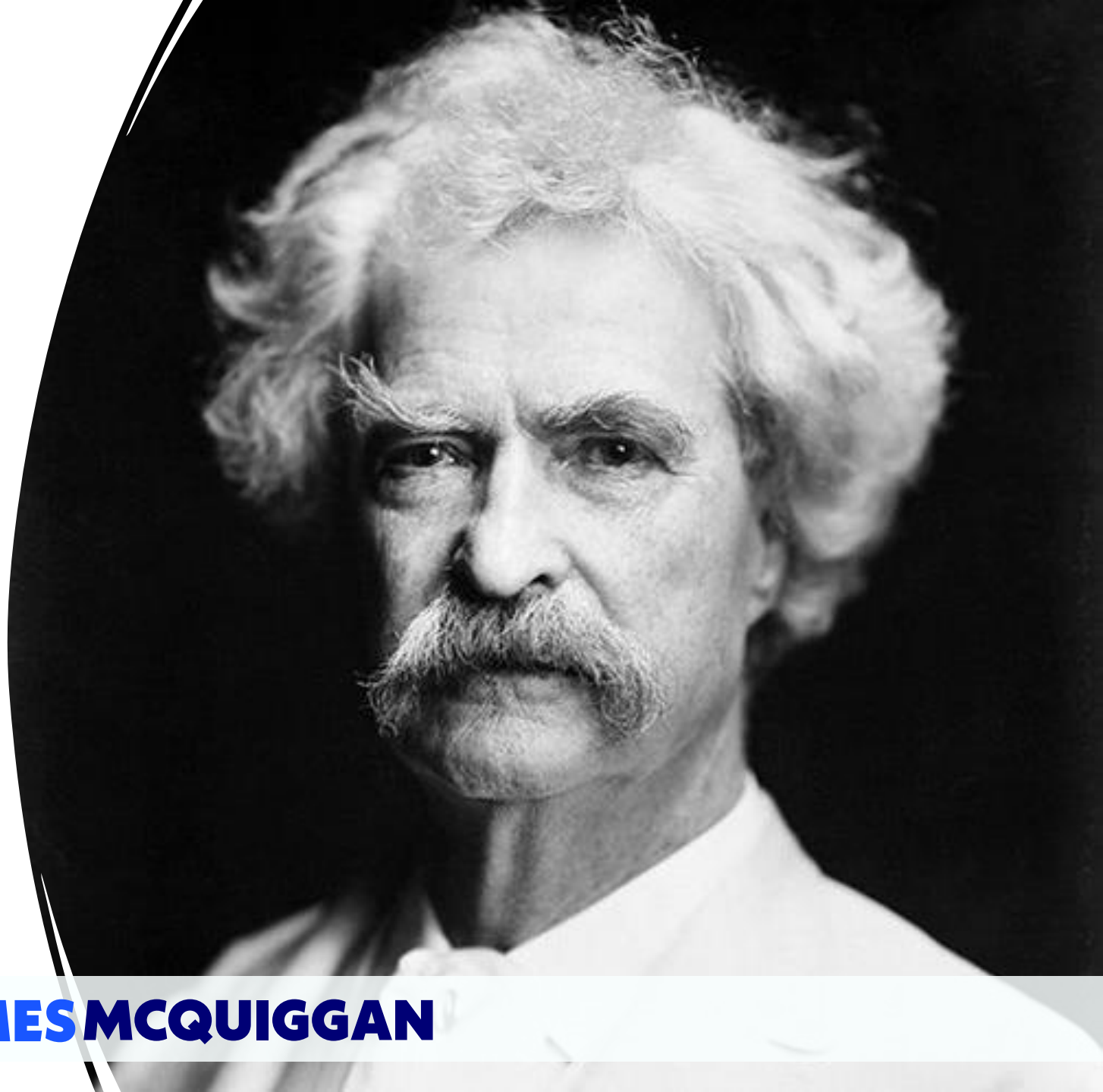
JAMES MCQUIGGAN

QUOTE

There are only two types of speakers:

Those who get nervous and liars.

- Mark Twain







GESTURES / BODY LANGUAGE – EVEN VIRTUALLY!

- Eye Contact
- Eliminate distracting mannerisms
- Be natural, spontaneous and conversational
- Let your body mirror your feelings
- Build self-confidence through preparation
- Practice, practice, practice



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

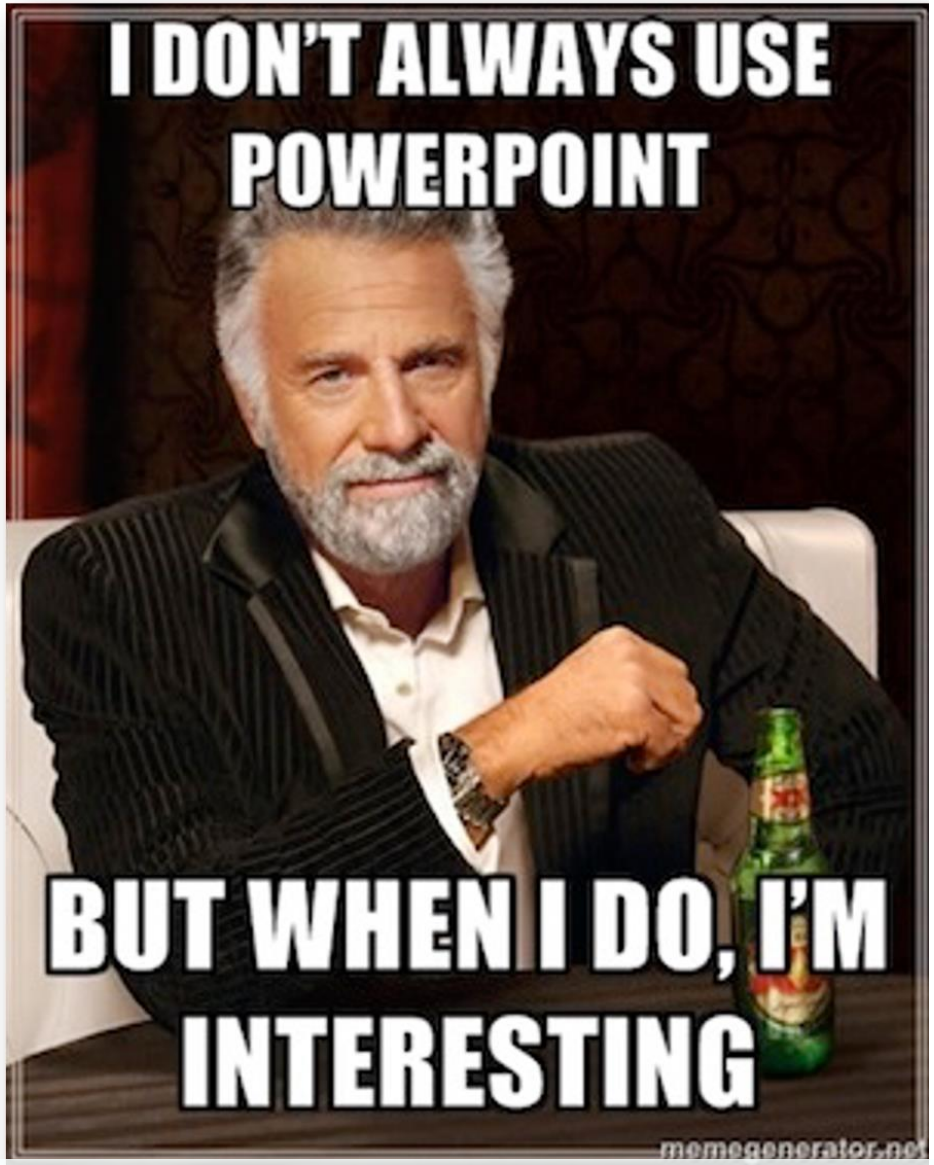


VOCAL VARIETY

- Pitch
- Duration
- Pause
- Volume (Loudness)
- Voice and Image
- Practice, practice, practice

7 POWERPOINT TIPS

1. Use Visuals to Present Data
2. Big, & Contrasting, Easy to read text
3. Bullet points not a sentence
4. Don't read the slides
5. Don't display your text all at once!
6. Keep the flying to Superman
7. Don't click and speak – speak and click!



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

MY 10 TIPS FOR BUILDING CONFIDENCE FOR SPEAKING

1. Practice, Practice, Practice
2. Know your material
3. Know the audience
4. Visualize yourself giving the speech
5. Concentrate on the message – not the medium



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

MY 10 TIPS FOR BUILDING CONFIDENCE FOR SPEAKING

6. Know the room
7. Don’t apologize - Sorry
8. Gaining experience = gaining confidence
9. Realize that people want you to succeed
10. Relax / Breathe





LET'S WORKSHOP A PRESENTATION

JAMES MCQUIGGAN

Workshop: Introductions

You'll build a 90-second intro, deliver it, get coached, and do it again — better.

1 Learn

Hooks, structure, delivery — the essentials you'll use right away.

2 Draft

10 minutes to build your 90 seconds: a hook + who / why / how.

3 Present

Deliver your 90 seconds to the room. Yes, everyone's nervous.

4 Feedback

Two things that worked, one change, one thing to try next.

5 Rework

Apply your one change. Refresh and tighten your talk.

6 Present Again

Round two. Feel the difference a single change makes.



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

YOUR OPENING

Opening – Teaser

- Pause, Statement, Question

What's in it for them?

Practice Your Opening!



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

EXERCISE — DRAFT YOUR 90 SECONDS INTRO

Start with a HOOK (pick one)

- **Ask a question** "How many of you have ever…?"
- **Startling fact** A number that makes them sit up.
- **"Imagine…"** Make them picture it.
- **Tell a short story** One moment, told fast.
- **"What if…?"** Paint a different future.
- **A sound bite** One line they'll remember.

Hooks: Grundei Coaching · grundeicoaching.com

Answer three questions

- **Who are you?** Name + one line of context.
- **Why should they care?** What's in it for them.
- **How do you help / solve it?** Your point or your ask.

Copy this skeleton

"**[Your hook]**. I'm **[name]**, and I **[what you do]**.
This matters to you because **[why they care]**.
The one thing to remember is **[your point]**."

Pick one hook, answer the three questions, then fill the skeleton. Messy is fine — just get it down.



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

How Feedback Works Here

Every person gets the same three things. Specific, kind, and short — no surprises, no teardowns.

2

What worked

- Specific things done well
- Avoid “good job”
- What landed.

1

One thing to sharpen

- A single high value tweak
- The tweak tied to a tip.
- One, easy tip to act on.

1

One thing to try

- An action for round two.
- Something to reach for
- Forget Round 1, it’s done

We all learn from each other! Most feedback is for the whole room, not just one person.



JAMES MCQUIGGAN

REVIEW TIPS

1. RECORD



Capture your presentation, opening, or hook on video without editing.

2. LISTEN (No Video)



Turn off the screen. Audit your tone, pace, filler words ("ums"), and vocal energy.

3. WATCH (No Audio)



Mute the volume. Check your posture, eye contact, hand gestures, and body language.

4. READ (Transcribe)



Read your exact transcript. Refine clarity, eliminate jargon, and polish narrative flow.

Workshop: Creating a Presentation

Let’s go through the process to build a presentation from soup to nuts.

1 Topic

Picking the right topic, use a case study, story, event,

2 Audience

Who is the audience, length of presentation

3 Format

Workshop, lecture, AMA, keynote, breakout session

4 Outline

Create the outline, with the elements of the presentation

5 Build Slides

If you’re using any, or notes and determine the visuals, props

6 Rehearse

Practice, Practice, Practice



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Most Security Talks Fail Before the First Slide

90s

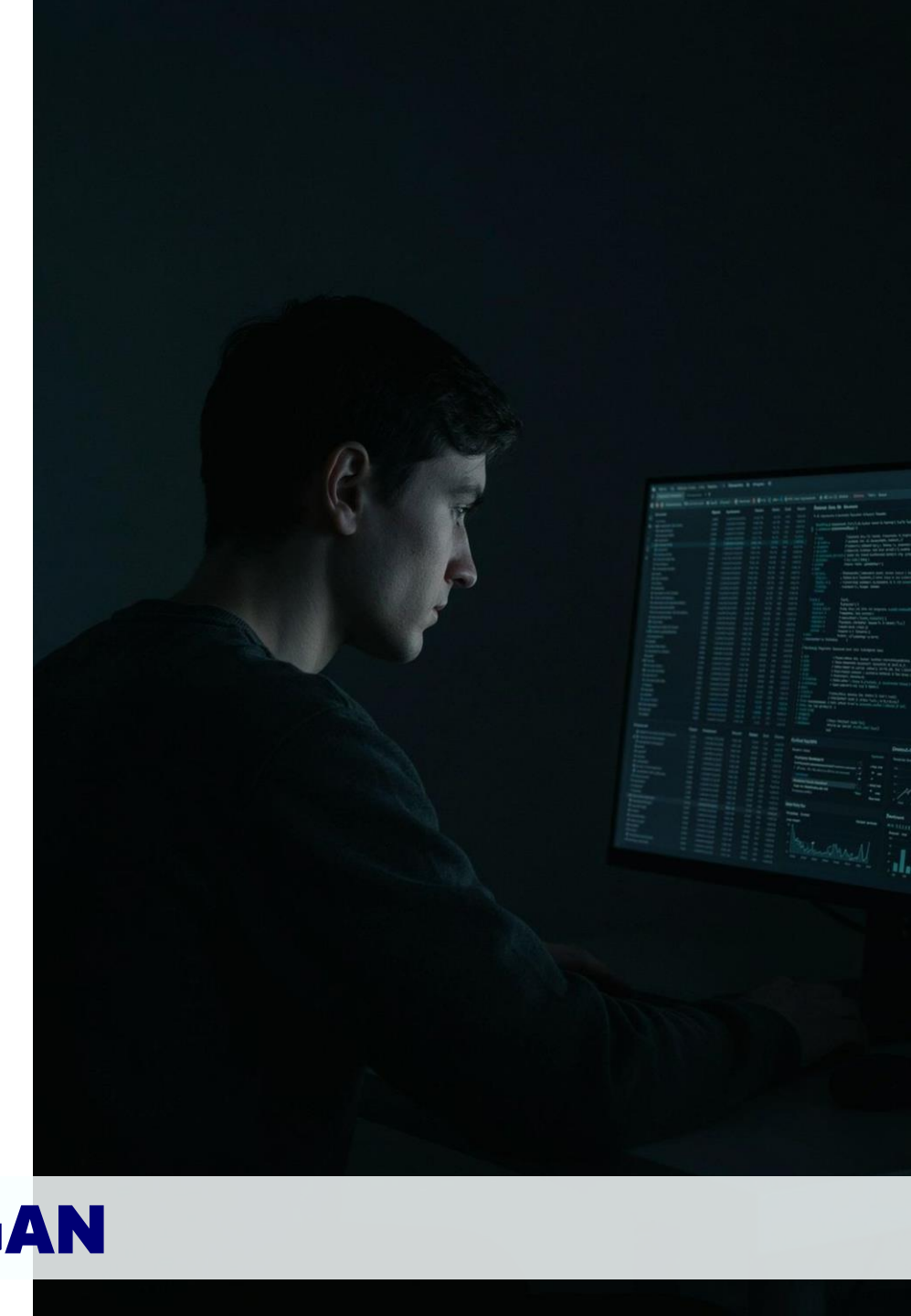
To Relevance

Audiences tune out if they don't see why it matters — and they never come back.

⚠

Depth Without Structure

Technical depth without narrative narrative is a report, not a presentation. You've lost the room.



The Fix

🎯

Treat your talk like a threat model — know know your target, define your objective, objective, execute with precision.

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Step 1: Know Your Audience Like You Know Your Attack Surface



Who Are They?

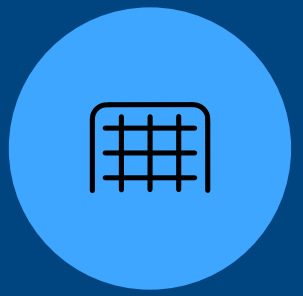
SOC analysts, pentesters, and architects each have different context and pain points. Speaking to everyone at once means connecting with no one.



What Do They Know?

Calibrate your jargon

Don't explain TCP/IP to a red teamer or assume a CISO knows what a reverse shell looks like.



What Do They Care About?

Lead with their priorities whether that is threat reduction, career growth, and staying ahead of adversaries.

Step 2: Define Your Call to Action & WIFM



CTA
Call to Action



J HGÌ
J OMPĀCEHŌ HP GŎØ
Ì ÑĒ



Mode
Your Purpose

JAMES MCQUIGGAN

Step 3: Lock In 3 Learning Objectives

- Audiences retain exactly 3 key ideas from any talk
- Make Each Objective Actionable
- Each Objective is on one section of your presentation



The Magic Number

Audiences retain exactly 3 key ideas from any talk

If you give them more and they remember less.

JAMES MCQUIGGAN



Step 4: Craft Your Opening

1

Relatable Moment

"When I was responding to a breach at breach at 2am…"

2

Unexpected Twist

Flip their expectation.

3

Bridge to Your Topic

Connect the emotion to your talk.

Step 5: Build the Body Around Your 3 Objectives

One section per objective. No blurring. No overlap.



Objective 1

Drop into a real CVE and and name the vulnerability, show the the blast radius.

Objective 2

Name a real breach or or campaign as audiences remember stories, not stats.

Objective 3 + CTA

Ï ÕMĎP ŘŎÞ ØŃMÕÕPŎ MŃPÒŎŌ ÑMØŐŘÆNÑŅŎØÑ POÑÒØMPPÑŌPÒŎŌ CÉŐŐCE MR MŘB

JAMES MCQUIGGAN

Step 6: Choose Your Storytelling Style



Hero's Journey

Defender faces threat, struggles, emerges transformed.
Best for keynotes.



Mini Pitch

Problem → Solution → Proof → Ask.
Best for budget and tool proposals.



Pixar Story

Î ŌŃŃ ÞŐŎŌ MPŒÖ ÑŷÞŌPŒÕ ŅŒÕMŒÕŘŷ
ĘÑCŒŅŎØŒŌŃŒŇÑŌP ØŃPØŎCŒÕÑŃPŒŒÑCB

JAMES MCQUIGGAN

Storytelling Style 1:
The Mini Pitch

Problem
A threat your audience knows.

Solution
Your approach in one sentence.

Proof
È Ö ÑPØÒÑ ÖØ
NÑŅÖØÑCMŅPÑØ
ØÑCŒ ÖB

Ask
The specific action action you want.



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Storytelling Style 2: The Hero's Journey

The Ordinary World

Defender on the job, normal day.

The Call to Adventure

Ė Ō MŌŎÖ MŒR MŐŐÑMÝØB Ï ŎÖ ÑPOÒŌNJ ÒŒĔÒŅŅB

The Transformation

The hero is changed whether good good or bad.

Return Transformed

New tools, processes, hard-won wisdom.

Pixar storytelling

FRAMEWORK

The beginning



1 Once upon a time,....

Everyday

The event



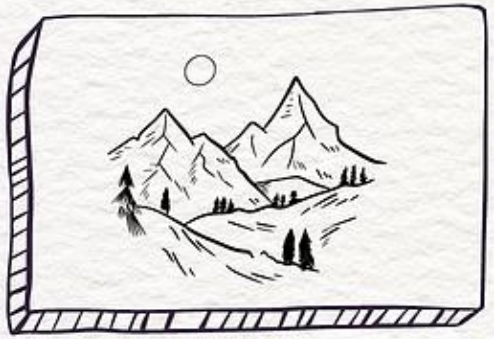
2 But one day, something out of ordinary happened

Interval



3

The climax



4 Unitl, finally.... the big change happened

End



5 and, ever since then....

Happily e



6



Step 7: Close with a STAR Moment



Situation

Ï ÑP PON CÉÑŌÑ à Ö MÔÑ ŘŎÞ ØMÞ ÑÒÑŌÑÑ ŅÑÑÕ PON Ö ŎÖ ÑŌP QÒÉÑØMÕŘB



Tension

Raise the stakes — data, reputation, or lives on the line.



Action

Be specific — exact decisions land; vague heroics don’t.



Result

Quantify the outcome — numbers make impact undeniable.

JAMES MCQUIGGAN



End Strong: Your Last Slide Is Your Most Important

Restate Your CTA

Make it impossible to forget. Say it plainly, say it with conviction, and make the next step obvious.

One Hallway Sentence

Leave them with one sentence they'll repeat to a colleague on the way out.

Don't End on "Questions?"

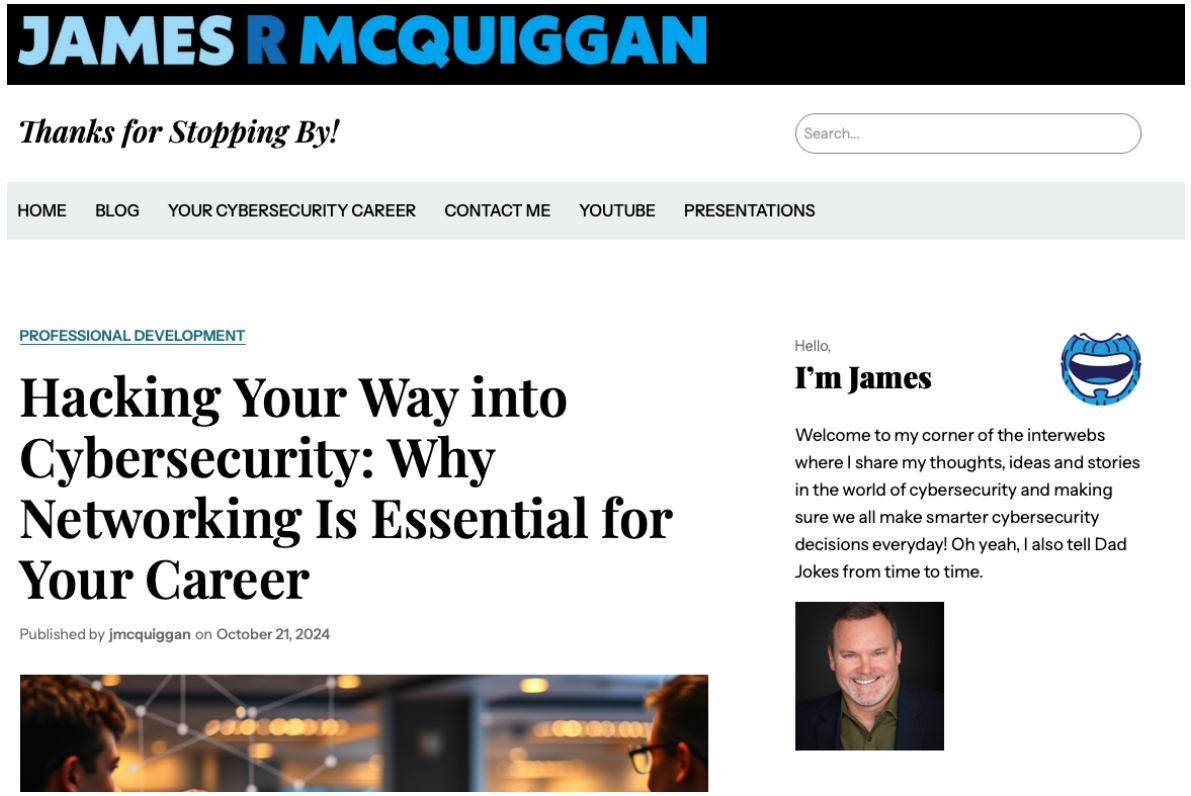
The best security talks end with a **challenge, commitment, or a call to arms**

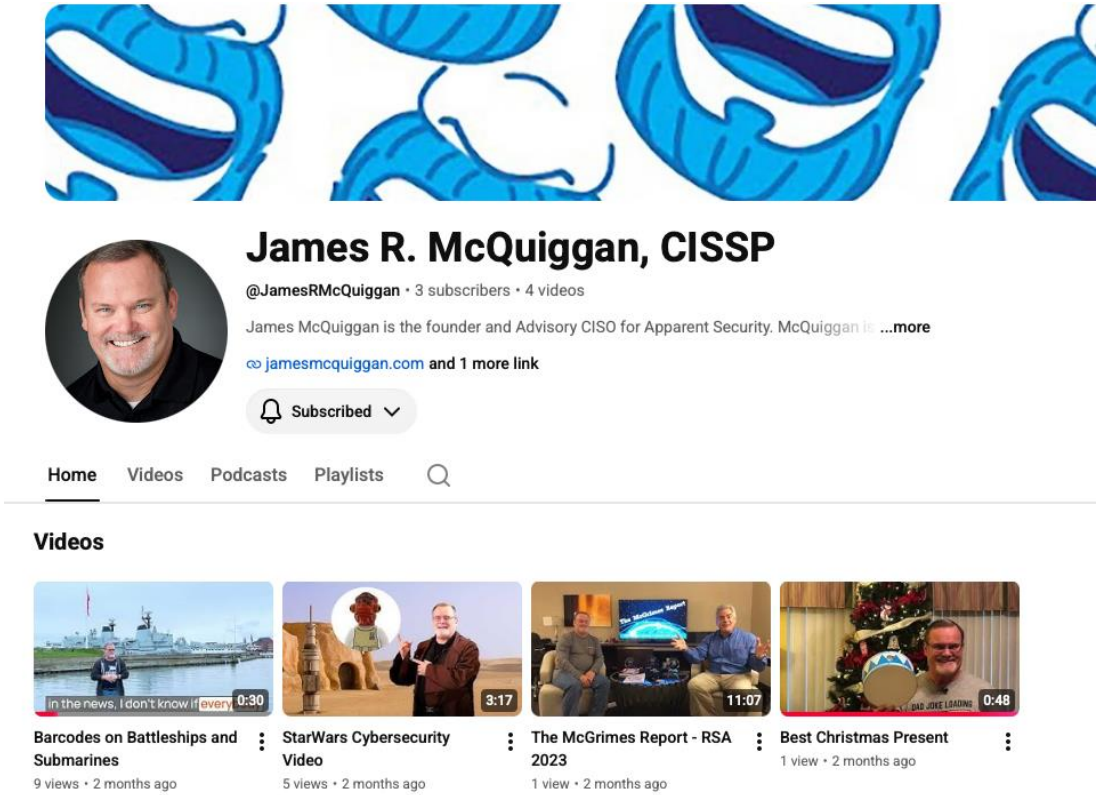
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LASTLY…

- Practice, Practice, Practice
- Be Confident
- You're the Expert

MY PRESENTATIONS





jamesmcquiggan.com

youtube.com/@JamesRMcQuiggan

REFERENCES & GUIDE

jamesmcquiggan.com





Building Speaking Confidence

- Practice, Practice, Practice
- Know your material
- Know the audience
- Know the room
- Visualize yourself giving the speech
- Concentrate on the message, not the medium
- Don't apologize – Sorry
- Realize that people want you to succeed
- Relax / Breathe
- Gaining experience = GAINING CONFIDENCE

Mastering Body Language

- Eye Contact
- Move, but with purpose
- Eliminate distracting mannerisms
- Be natural, spontaneous & conversational
- Let your body mirror your feelings
- Build self-confidence through preparation
- Practice, practice, practice

Develop Vocal Variety

- Pitch
- Duration
- Pause
- Volume (Loudness)
- Voice and Image
- Avoid Crutch words
- Practice, practice, practice

PowerPoint Tips

- Contrast – light on dark
- Don't read the slides
- Make your text large
- Choose easy to read colors
- Bullet points not a sentence
- Keep the flying to Superman
- Avoid eye charts – 7 bullets max
- Don't display your text all at once!
- Use Visuals to Present Data
- Don't click and speak – speak & click

REFERENCES & GUIDE







Hook Your First 30 Seconds

Grab attention before you introduce yourself. Pick one:

- Ask a question (or a series of them)
- Startling fact or statistic
- "Imagine…" – make them picture it
- Tell a short story
- A "What if…?" scenario
- A compelling sound bite

The 3-Question Spine

Every talk should answer these, in order:

- Who are you?
- Why should I care?
- How do you solve my problem?

Source: Grundei Coaching · grundeicoaching.com · meridithgrundei.com

Resources

- Toastmasters International – find a local chapter
- Meridith Grundei – TikTok / YouTube – Online Community
- Neil Gordon – TikTok / Newsletter – 30 days of tips
- "Talk Like TED" by Carmine Gallo
- "Presentation Zen" by Garr Reynolds – slide design
- "Made to Stick" by Chip & Dan Heath – memorable messaging.